

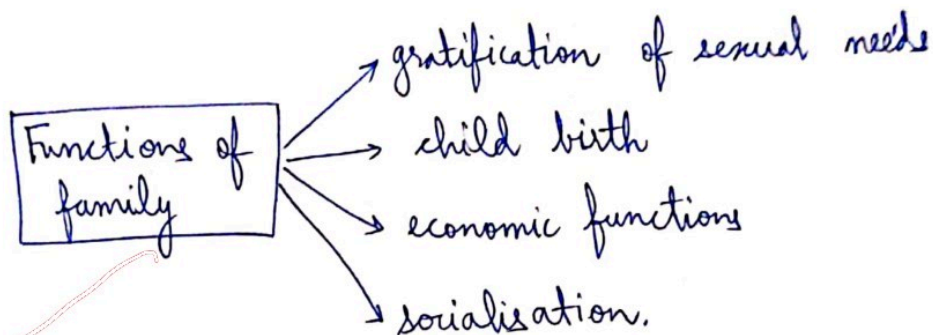
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(c) Define family and discuss the universal conception of family

Murdock in his book 'Social Structure (1962)' defined family as unit consisting of married couple and their children.



Murdock argued that since marriage is universal, so should be family. He further added ~~it~~ after studying various communities that since nuclear families perform all these functions, nuclear families are universal.

Since family contains atleast one nuclear family, so family should also be universal.

Kathleen Gough based on this discussion pointed that these functions do not apply to all societies.

1) Justification of sexual needs and child birth not applicable to:

- a) Woman - woman marriage among Nuer
- b) Ghost marriage
- c) Nayar of Malabar

2) Economic ~~also~~ functions:

- a) In modern societies, many economic functions like providing salaries, pensions are done by state
- b) Kibbutz of Israel : state take care of economic functions.

3) Socialization

- i) In many extended families, socialization is done by grand fathers.
- ii) Among various communities of China, socialization is ~~done~~ never done by family.

Hence, Kathleen Gough remarked that ~~the~~ family is not universal. Rather what is structurally and functionally universal is mother-child unit.

